

almost two-thirds of the chief economists believe a global recession is likely this year, with 18 per cent considering it extremely likely. This is more than twice as many as in the previous survey conducted last September. Only a third of the respondents consider a global recession to be unlikely this year, although the survey also points out a number of potential sources of optimism at the start of 2023, including strong household finances and easing inflationary pressures, among others.

India stands apart in this regard, with almost six in 10 Indian CEOs (57 per cent) polled by PwC expressing optimism about the country's economy over the next 12 months. In comparison, only 37 per cent of Asia Pacific CEOs and 29 per cent of global CEOs expect economic growth to improve in their countries or regions in this period. And even as the captains of western industry seem to be very pessimistic, it was Indian companies, and state and central government ministers, who were out in strength at a time when the Chinese gave the forum a miss, again, and when the Russians are no longer welcome at any global gathering.

Asked about where India stands in the global scheme of things in 2023, PwC Global Chairman Bob Moritz said that while Indian CEOs are pessimistic about the global economy, they are much more optimistic about the local economy, and their ability to raise revenues. "This is a big opportunity for India—it continues to be an asset and a deployment for human capital to the world. If India can also play in the green supply chain, that will be a huge benefit for the world," he said.

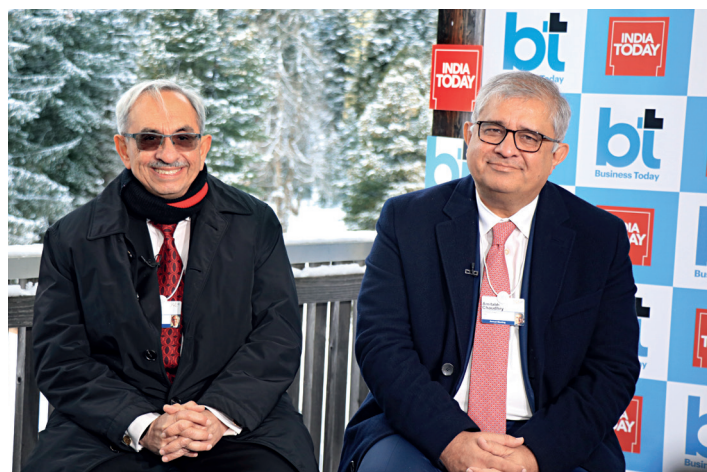
But there is far more about how the India story resonated here. WEF Founder and Executive Chairman Klaus Schwab underlined this when he said that "India remains a bright spot amid global geo-economics



(From left) Siddharth Zarabi with Sumant Sinha, Chairman & CEO of ReNew Power; Ajit Gulabchand, CMD of HCC; and Arunabha Ghosh, CEO of CEEW



Siddharth Zarabi (left) with Robert E. Moritz, Global Chairman of PwC



Nadir Godrej (left), Chairman and Managing Director of Godrej Industries, with Amitabh Chaudhry, MD & CEO of Axis Bank